

TEDXNEWY · YOUTH FUTURES LAB · FRIDAY 7 AUGUST 2026

SMART + KIND

NEWCASTLE

Welcome — find your table, meet your team.

We begin at 10:00.

10:00 • WELCOME

IDEAS WORTH SHARING

This is a TEDx event, and TEDx is built on a simple belief: a good idea, clearly told, can change how people see things.

Today we're pointing that belief at the city you live in.

THE CHALLENGE BRIEF

YOU ARE CONSULTANTS TO THE COUNCIL

Your job today: choose one part of city life and design a new idea, improvement, service, space, campaign, or invention that would make Newcastle both **smarter** and **kinder** for young people.

The future isn't only something adults build for young people. It's something young people should help imagine, shape, challenge, and explain.

THE TWO WORDS THAT MATTER

SMART IS NOT ENOUGH. KIND IS NOT ENOUGH.

SMART

Good systems, transport, information, design, decisions. A city that works well.

KIND

Safe, welcoming, creative, inclusive, affordable, accessible, human. A city that cares about people.

A smart city is not just a city with better technology. A smart city should also be kinder, fairer, safer, more creative, and more human.

THE SHAPE OF THE DAY

HERE'S THE PLAN

10:15	Workshop 1 — See the City Differently
11:00	Break
11:15	Workshop 2 — Build the Future Proposal
12:15	Lunch — your ideas stay on the tables
1:00	Rehearsal + pitch coaching
1:30	Final pitches — 2 minutes per team
2:20	Reflection + recognitions

WORKSHOP 1 • 10:15 - 11:00

SEE THE CITY DIFFERENTLY

Choose a focus area. Find a real problem. Start shaping an idea.

FIRST: CHOOSE YOUR FOCUS AREA

PICK WHAT ACTUALLY AFFECTS YOU

GETTING AROUND
moving freely, safely, cheaply, independently

PLACES TO HANG OUT
time without buying something or being moved on

DIGITAL LIFE
tech that connects, not controls

SAFE, NOT WATCHED
feeling safe without feeling surveilled

THE COST OF BEING YOUNG
what if being a teenager cost less?

LEARNING BEYOND SCHOOL
places to study, make, experiment

MENTAL HEALTH & QUIET
where to go when it's all too much

FOOD & SOCIAL LIFE
affordable, welcoming places to eat & meet

CREATIVE EXPRESSION
making & sharing art, music, games, film

FUTURE YOU: NEWCASTLE AT 25
would you stay? what would need to change?

CHOOSE YOUR AREA

08 : 00

PROBLEM DISCOVERY

WHAT'S REALLY GOING ON?

- What is the current problem?
- Who does it affect?
- Where does it happen?
- What makes it frustrating, unfair, unsafe, boring, expensive, inaccessible, or overlooked?
- **What do adults misunderstand about this issue?**

PROBLEM DISCOVERY

15 : 00

IDEA GENERATION

MANY IDEAS FIRST. THEN CHOOSE **ONE**.

A PLACE

A SERVICE

AN APP

A CAMPAIGN

AN EVENT

A NEW RULE

A MAP

A TRANSPORT FIX

A PUBLIC ARTWORK

A PHYSICAL OBJECT

A NEW KIND OF YOUTH SPACE

IDEA GENERATION

15 : 00

MINI PITCH LESSON – HOW YOU'LL TELL IT

YOUR WHOLE PITCH, IN THREE LINES

RIGHT NOW...

what is the problem?

BUT WHAT IF...

what is your idea?

IMAGINE IF...

what changes because of your idea?

11:00

BREAK

Back at 11:15 — then we build.

BREAK

15:00

WORKSHOP 2 • 11:15 - 12:15

BUILD THE FUTURE PROPOSAL

Make your idea visible. Create at least one of:

CONCEPT POSTER

MAP

LABELLED SKETCH

SERVICE PLAN

APP MOCK-UP

ADVERTISEMENT

SLOGAN

PROTOTYPE MODEL

BEFORE / AFTER PLAN

STORYBOARD

COUNCIL PROPOSAL

BUILD TIME

60 : 00

KEEP CHECKING YOUR IDEA AGAINST THESE

THE EIGHT IDEA CHECKS

- 1 What is the problem?
- 2 What is your solution?
- 3 Who is it for?
- 4 Where would it happen?
- 5 How is it **smart**?
- 6 How is it **kind**?
- 7 What would the council need to do?
- 8 What would success look like?

~11:45 • THE REMIX MOMENT

STEAL ONE IDEA KINDLY

Send one or two people from your team to visit another table. Find one idea you like, bring it back, and use it to improve your own proposal.

REMIX

05 : 00

12:15 • LUNCH

LUNCH + MINI-EXPO

Leave your posters and materials on the tables — wander around and see what every other team is imagining.

Back at 1:00 for rehearsal.

LUNCH

45 : 00

PRACTISE IT OUT LOUD

RIGHT NOW...	the problem
BUT WHAT IF...	your idea
IMAGINE IF...	the future it creates
SMARTER BECAUSE...	the system benefit
KINDER BECAUSE...	the human benefit

- Start with the problem, not the product
- One clear idea · simple language · share the talking
- Use a real example: "*Imagine you're 15 and...*"
- Finish with a strong sentence

REHEARSAL

30 : 00

1:30 • FINAL PITCHES

OVER TO YOU

Two minutes per team. Panel — you're listening for ideas that are practical, ideas that show us something adults miss, and ideas worth taking further.

PITCH TIMER — RESET BETWEEN TEAMS

02 : 00

2:20 • REFLECTION

WHAT DID WE HEAR TODAY?

- What kept coming up, table after table?
- What did young people notice that adults might miss?
- **What changes because these ideas exist?**

RECOGNITIONS

NO SINGLE WINNER TODAY – ON PURPOSE

MOST IMAGINATIVE FUTURE

SMARTEST SYSTEM IDEA

KINDEST CITY IDEA

STRONGEST YOUTH VOICE

BEST PITCH

BEST VISUAL CONCEPT

MOST PRACTICAL COUNCIL PROPOSAL

BEST "WE HADN'T THOUGHT OF THAT" IDEA

THANK YOU

KEEP NOTICING

Young people deserve a city that doesn't just include them in the future, but listens to them now. Today, it did.

Thank you to every consultant in this room. Get home safely.